

UNIVERSITY OF THE INCARNATE WORD

HSI: Battle of the Brains 2026



5 Page Business Plan: NARAH

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Table of Contents

Table of Contents.....	2
Company Background.....	3
Brand History.....	3
Purpose and Problem to Solve.....	3
Goals and Objectives.....	3
KPI – AI Shopping Inclusion Rate:.....	3
Business Model.....	3
Operations Dashboard & Memberships.....	4
Key resources and capabilities.....	4
Business risks.....	5
Privacy.....	5
Marketing.....	6
Market analysis.....	6
Marketing and advertising.....	7
Financial Projections.....	7
Funding.....	7
Pricing.....	7
Three-Year Projection.....	7
Break-even and ROI.....	7
Works Cited.....	8

Company Background

Brand History

NARAH was founded by a team of five students at the University of the Incarnate Word, bringing together finance, international business, and data analytics. The idea came from a shift in consumers' shopping habits. More people now ask an AI assistant what to buy instead of searching and comparing websites, which can result in unreliable information and reduced exposure for companies.

Purpose and Problem to Solve

In August 2026, AI-driven traffic in retail grew 127% YoY and is expected to remain strong and increase to 130% during the holidays (Adobe). When a shopper asks AI for the best laptop under \$500, they often make a decision without ever visiting a company's website. If a company isn't mentioned, or its product is described incorrectly (wrong price or features), the customer may never reach its website. Companies lose visibility and traffic they can't measure, and customers risk buying based on unreliable information.

NARAH aims to close that gap. Shoppers connect NARAH to their AI assistant of choice, the same way students connect Canva. When they ask about a product, their AI pulls verified information from official and authorized company/retailer sites. Companies subscribe (tier model provided in the Business section) to keep their product information complete and accurate, and use the NARAH dashboard to monitor how they appear in AI answers and where to improve. The NARAH dashboard will provide relevant information to the company using product feeds, web crawlers and APIs. Once a company makes adjustments, AI can provide customers with information that is more accurate and up to date.

Goals and Objectives

- Keep 95% or more of tracked product facts stated correctly across AI assistants
- Reduce returns and support tickets tied to AI misinformation by 10% during the pilot, measured before and after
- Grow each client's AI-referred traffic and conversions, tracked in dashboard reports
- Reach 50,000 shoppers using the NARAH connector in the first year

KPI – AI Shopping Inclusion Rate:

This KPI measures how frequently a client's products appear in AI-generated shopping recommendations. NARAH's goal is to increase this inclusion rate by 5 percentage points within 90 days. Tracking this KPI helps determine whether the platform is improving the visibility of a client's products across AI shopping tools and whether NARAH is creating measurable value for the business.

Business Model

NARAH would operate as a B2B model in which it would generate revenue by providing a membership-based website that makes decision-making in companies easier by providing a summary shown on a dashboard that contains statistics based on the interactions potential consumers have with their official page, top products on their website and regions

where their website was most visited. The level of detail provided on the dashboard would depend on the company's membership subscription.

NARAH obtains this information by using an API system that acts as a bridge of communication between AI and the participating company's data. NARAH protects personal identifiable information (PII) like, names, email addresses, and phone numbers, while still recording demographic and behavioral data to help companies measure what products certain groups demand for. Web crawlers would collect and update product information specifically from company official websites.

NARAH's AI Guard Rails create this selectivity, by ensuring that information comes solely from verified sources (Krantz and Jonker).

Operations Dashboard & Memberships

The dashboard is NARAH's main component, aside from ensuring product information credibility. NARAH offers different tier memberships such as Bronze, Silver, and Gold that increasingly provide specialized information from user and AI interactions regarding certain products.

Bronze:

- Verified company information, including product details, prices, and availability
- Monthly reports on product recommendation frequency
- Connection with one AI platform
- Monthly website crawling to reflect updates and changes

Silver:

- Everything included in Bronze
- Weekly website crawling and SEO recommendations
- Product verification
- Competitor and customer insight analysis
- Weekly AI reports with customer questions, product awareness, purchase factors, and multi-platform support

Gold:

- Everything included in Silver
- Real-time website crawling and verified information
- Advanced guardrails to minimize AI hallucinations
- Real-time traffic-based recommendations
- Customer and product insights based on purchasing behavior and frequently asked questions

Key resources and capabilities

The company depends on many key resources and capabilities that allow it to operate correctly and to compete with other companies in the same industry. Some of its most

important resources are the technology, their employees, the customer relationships, and the strategic partnerships with other companies. These resources help the company to improve its operations, to provide a better service, and respond to changes in the market.

Also, the company's capabilities like innovation, the customer service, and the ability to adapt to new technologies for the client, can create a clear advantage over the competitors. Maintaining and improving the resources is important because they influence directly with the company's performance and the company's long-term growth.

Business risks

NARAH also faces different risks and challenges that can affect operations, profitability and ability to grow.

Biases

Member Selection Bias: this occurs when the businesses that join NARAH are not representative of the entire market.

Pay-to-Play Bias: Businesses paying more could receive greater exposure.

Data Availability Bias: Some companies provide much more information than others.

Algorithmic Bias: The recommendation system develops patterns that unintentionally favor certain businesses.

Privacy

A primary concern is regarding our collection of information when proposing factual information to the company's customers. Websites use cookies to collect and store information about a user's browsing activity, preferences, and interactions (Bigdoli 93).

Since our platform is reliant on analyzing customer traffic and behavior to provide companies with market statistics, we must ensure that user data is being collected responsibly.

We can do this by implementing a clear privacy policy and cookie consent system that informs users about what information is being collected and how it will be used. Users also have the opportunity to opt out of optional personalized data collection, this allows our platform to prioritize transparency and user privacy, and still fulfill providing companies with useful market insight.

NARAH's Guard Rail framework acts as a trust and verification layer between AI systems and consumers using an API; it verifies that product information comes from trusted business sources while protecting customer data. These safeguards reduce misinformation, protect personal information, and provide consumers with more reliable products.

Since NARAH will be serving companies and users strictly in the United States, the website would have to adhere to the Federal Trade Commission (FTC). Under the Federal Trade Commission (FTC), NARAH will be expected to make truthful privacy representations, protect consumer information through reasonable safeguards, avoid deceptive or misleading data practices, and provide clear notice regarding how consumer information is collected, used, and shared.

When NARAH connects American customers to AI platforms (e.g. Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot), the following would need to be ensured: user conversations will not be sold to third parties, personal data will not be used to train AI models without appropriate authorization, only necessary metadata and analytics will be collected for platform improvement, AI recommendation processes should be monitored for fairness, transparency, and accuracy, sensitive information should be encrypted and securely stored.

Carbon Footprint Risk, NARAH depends on AI processing, cloud computing, and frequent website crawling, which can increase energy use as the company grows. This could also increase its carbon footprint and become a concern for clients that care about sustainability. To reduce this risk, NARAH can use more energy-efficient cloud providers, data centers powered by renewable energy, and better crawling schedules to avoid unnecessary energy use.

Marketing

Market analysis

There are many companies that depend on website traffic. The amount of companies that have been affected by AI shopping has been increasing, “Retailers, news publications, and marketing agencies saw drops in traffic of 20–40 percent, with much of that decline coming from a loss of organic search traffic.” (Kellogg Insight).

NARAH will offer our service to the companies that are suffering from AI shopping. Our customers will mainly be large companies and retailers that sell physical products in the United States, which would have to pay a subscription, either annually or monthly, so we would become a B2B company.

On the B2C side, NARAH will act as an intermediary company. Companies would choose us apart from other tools, because we only offer data to customers from the company's official websites. Research from Pew Research Center found that users clicked traditional search results in only 8% of searches containing an AI summary, compared with 15% when no AI summary appeared. (Pew Research Center).

Our main competitor would be AI and the company's virtual assistant from some companies that help the consumer search for a product on their own website. Because AI can do a deep search according to the consumer preferences, but this may lead to an error due to the general internet search it does, it may not be off of the official company site.

NARAH's second competitor, the virtual assistant, a chatbot that is installed in the official site of the company to quickly search for what the customer is looking for, but you have to search for the official website to be able to use it. NARAH's will make consumer's lives easier and faster, by providing them a website that does this research for them but based only on official websites. And to solve the problem companies are dealing with regarding AI shopping, and losing the record on website visits.

With NARAH they won't lose track of how many customers click on their website through AI chats, how many searched for the official website, which products are the best

sellers, and which products people don't even click on, all this information summarized in a Dashboard. This way, NARAH will be helping both the companies and consumers.

Marketing and advertising

The three ways we would advertise to potential NARAH users would be through social media to reach the sector that are more likely to use our website, we would also implement email advertising with potential companies so they hire our website service, and we would make us notice with everyone through billboards all around the US.

Financial Projections

Funding

NARAH will seek \$175,000 in seed funding from Alamo Angels; one of Texas's most active angel investor networks (Alamo Angels, 2026). This will cover startup costs and operating losses until NARAH turns profitable in Year 3. Founders will be unpaid in Year 1.

Startup & Operating Costs

[\[Spreadsheet\]](#)

Pricing

Tiered monthly subscriptions: **Starter \$299, Growth \$799, and Enterprise from \$5,000.** Enterprise is priced this way because it verifies accuracy, drafts fixes and reaches shoppers through its connector.

Three-Year Projection

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Clients (end of year)	10	40	100
Revenue	\$58,100	\$290,700	\$814,000
Costs	\$179,200	\$220,000	\$380,000
Profit / (Loss)	(\$121,100)	\$70,700	\$434,000

SOC 2 security certification is planned for Year 2 to support enterprise sales and is included in Year 2 costs.

Break-even and ROI

A brand with 10,000 AI-referred visits a month, a 2% conversion rate and a \$700 average order that grows AI visits by 20% earns about \$28,000 more per month, roughly 35 times the cost of a Growth plan. At enterprise scale, 100,000 AI-referred visits a month, the same growth adds about \$280,000 per month, roughly 56 times the cost of a \$5,000 Enterprise plan.

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